eosc-basic-compliance — analysis workflow

What the test suite does, step by step, for every checklist requirement

Repository: github.com/marioreale/eosc-basic-compliance

20 October 2026 (checklist v3.2, per-node time limit, sixteen nodes) — built from the Markdown guides in the same commit

What the test suite actually does, step by step, when it assesses a node against the **Node Landing Page Verification Checklist v3.2** (28 September 2026).

This document is written against the code in src/basic_check/ as it stands, not against the design intent. Where the implementation is weaker than the checklist wording, that is stated rather than smoothed over — the point of this document is that a reviewer can predict the verdict before running the tool, and can tell which verdicts are worth trusting. It was last checked against commit 6423432 on 26 September 2026, and again on 29 September 2026 for checklist v3.2, when section 5 gained the item 5 rule of v3.2 and the line numbers of checks.py were re-measured: every file.py:line reference below points at the current source, and the figures quoted from runs say which run they come from.

Reading order: sections 1–4 describe the machinery shared by every point; section 5 gives the decision procedure for each of the ten points individually; section 6 lists the known ways the machinery can be wrong; section 7 describes the output; section 8 gives three worked examples — adding a node, changing a node's URL, and moving to a new checklist revision — with every command.

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1. The three stages

The tool is deliberately split so that **no judgement is ever made against a live website**. Evidence is captured once, written to disk, and every verdict is then derived from that file.

Stage	Command	Reads	Writes	Network
1. Collect	collect	nodes.yaml	results/evidence/<node>.json (personal data masked), results/evidence/screenshots/<node>.png	yes
2. Assess	assess	evidence JSON + checklist/v3.2.yaml	results/results.json	**no**
3. Report	(part of assess)	the run dict in memory, masked again before rendering	index.html, results.md, results.csv, checklist-v3.2.html	no

run is stages 1–3 in one invocation. points and show are inspection commands and assess nothing.

Two consequences of the split matter in practice:

- **A verdict can be re-derived without touching the node's server.** After a checklist reinterpretation or a bug fix, re-running `assess` against the stored evidence regenerates every verdict offline, and the new report can be diffed against the old one.
- **The checks cannot see anything the collector did not record.** If a fact is not in `PageEvidence`, no check can use it — see section 3.

The phases in time, their options, and what to re-run

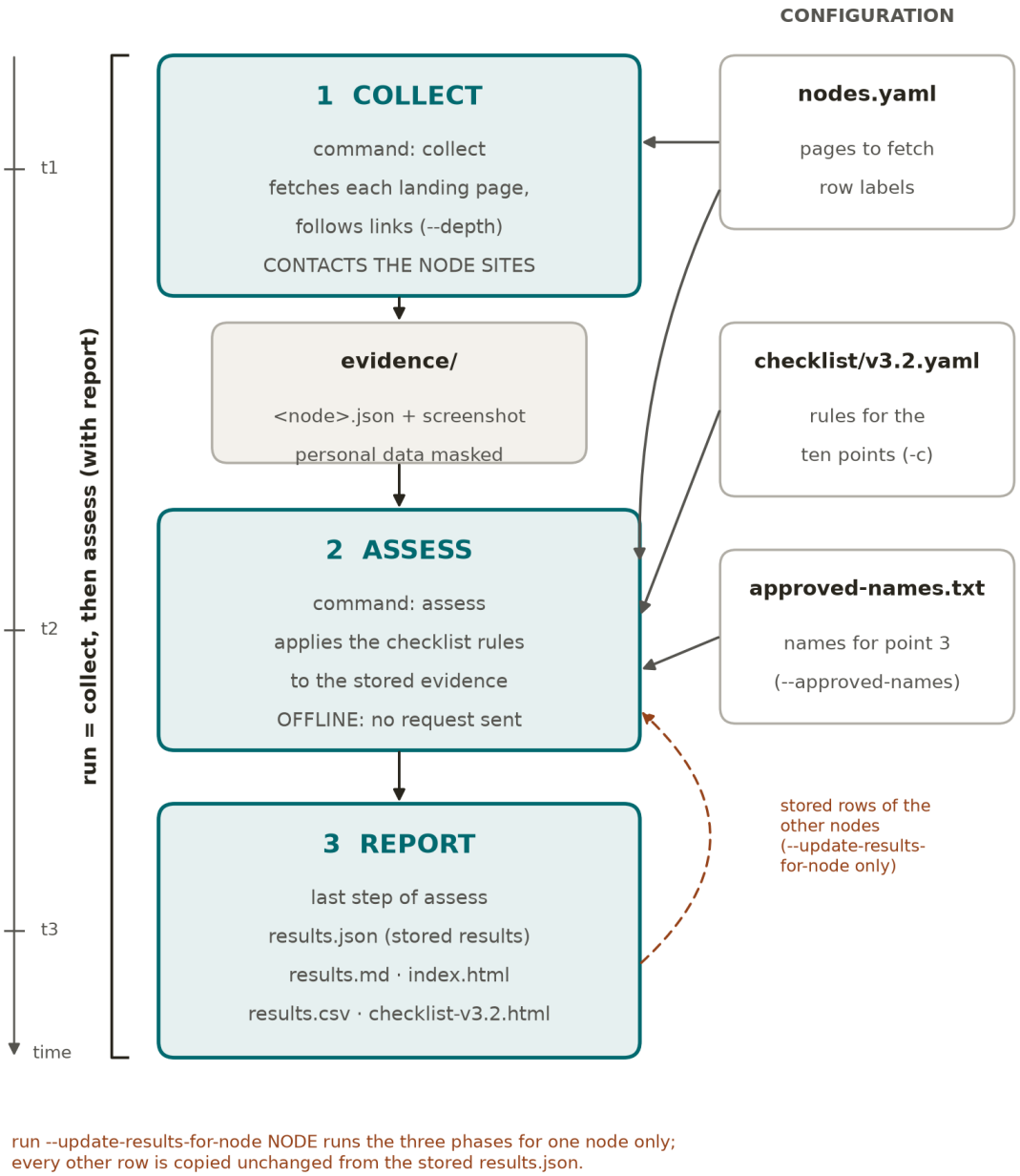


Figure 1. The three phases in execution order: collect contacts the nodes, assess and report work offline, and run performs all three.

The phases run strictly in this order, and each one reads only what the one before it wrote to disk. **Collect** is the only phase that contacts the nodes. It reads nodes.yaml and writes evidence/<node>.json and a screenshot per node. **Assess** reads that evidence, the checklist and the approved-name list, and sends no request. **Report** is the last step of assess: it writes results.json, results.md, index.html, results.csv and

checklist-v3.2.html. run performs the three in one invocation. With --update-results-for-node, run does the same for one node only, and results.json supplies every other row unchanged. points and show only read, so they never need re-running.

Options of each phase. ✓ means the command accepts the option. Every command also takes --help.

Option	collect	assess	run	What it does
--nodes, -n <file>	✓	✓	✓	Node list to use instead of nodes.yaml
--results <dir>	✓	✓	✓	Folder to write to or read from instead of results/
--only <ids>	✓	✓	✓	Fetch only these node ids
--skip <ids or names>	✓	✓	✓	Leave these nodes out entirely; the report says so
--url <url>	✓	✓	✓	Check a page not in nodes.yaml (writes to results/one-off/)
--eosc-page <url>	✓	✓	✓	With one --url: that node's own eosc.eu page, for point 4
--node <id or name>	✓	✓	✓	One configured node at the alternative page given with --url
--delay <s>	✓	—	✓	Seconds between hosts (default 2.0)
--depth 0/1/2	✓	—	✓	How far to follow links (default 1)
--max-children <n>	✓	—	—	Linked pages followed per node at depth 1 (default 8; run always uses 8)
--fetch-budget <n>	✓	—	✓	Depth 2 only: ceiling on second-hop requests (default 60)
--node-timeout <s>	✓	—	✓	Most seconds per node before it is abandoned as ERROR (default

Option	collect	assess	run	What it does
				300; 0 = no limit)
--checklist, -c <file>	—	✓	✓	Checklist revision to apply (default checklist/v3.2.yaml)
--approved-names <file>	—	✓	✓	Approved-name list for point 3 (default checklist/approved-names.txt)
--no-approved-names	—	✓	✓	Use no name list at all
--strict-separators	—	✓	✓	Match separators in approved names literally
--run <label>	—	✓	✓	Label recorded in every report (default: UTC time)
--update-results-for-node <node>	—	✓	✓	Update only that node's row in the stored results; assess re-judges its saved evidence, run fetches it again
--accept-error	—	—	✓	With --update-results-for-node: merge the row even if the fetch failed

What to launch again after a change. Which phase has to be repeated depends on which input changed. A change to nodes.yaml needs a new collection for the nodes concerned. A change to the checklist or to the name list needs only a new assessment, which is offline. --update-results-for-node refuses when the checklist or the approved-name list differs from the stored results', because a row judged by other rules would not be comparable with the others. In those cases, every row is assessed again from its stored evidence.

You change	Launch again	Sites contacted	The other nodes' rows
Add a node: an entry in nodes.yaml and its approved name in checklist/approved-names.txt (and -scoped.txt)	collect --only <new id>, then assess without --only	the new node only	Re-judged, offline, from their stored evidence, because the approved-name list used for point 3 changed
Add a node whose approved name is	run --update-results-for-node <new id>	the new node only	Kept unchanged; the new row is inserted in

You change	Launch again	Sites contacted	The other nodes' rows
already in checklist/approved-names.txt			nodes.yaml order
Change a node's landing page URL (basic-check --update-nlp <id> <URL>, or by hand)	run --update-results-for-node <id>	that node only	Kept unchanged
Go back to the node list as downloaded (basic-check --restore-default-config)	For each node it lists as URL restored: run --update-results-for-node <id>. If it lists nodes added back or removed: assess	the restored nodes only	Kept unchanged; re-judged offline if nodes were added back or removed
Change the reference checklist (a new checklist/vX.Y.yaml, made the default in DEFAULT_CHECKLIST or passed with -c)	assess	none	All re-judged, offline, from the stored evidence

assess alone is not enough after a URL change. The node's evidence still comes from the old page, so assess warns and both reports carry an **Evidence from a different URL** banner. After a checklist change, a new collect (or a full run) is needed only if the new revision asks for something the collector does not record (section 3), or if you want a fresh capture date. For the full procedure of each case, with every file and command, see the worked examples in section 8. Each command writes to results/, the published run, by default. Add --results /tmp/copy to work on a copy first. The published run covers all sixteen nodes, so no --skip is needed for the same scope. With an explicit --results, --only also narrows the report to those nodes, which is why the table runs assess without it.

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2. Stage 1 — collection

Per node, in order:

1. **robots.txt for the landing page host** (_robots, fetch.py:208). Fetched with a plain HTTP client (httpx, not the browser), with the tool's own User-Agent string. Three outcomes:
    - disallowed → error = "not fetched: robots.txt disallows it", evidence record returned immediately, **every point becomes ERROR**. This is not hypothetical: on a trial run on 25 September 2026, BBMRI-ERIC's new dev3. address served User-agent: * / Disallow: /, and all ten of its points were ERROR;
    - HTTP ≠ 200 → treated as "nothing disallowed", proceed;
    - unreachable → proceed with one request, and the reason is recorded in robots_note. A network failure is not read as permission, but it is also not read as a prohibition.
2. **Render in a real browser.** Chromium via Playwright, viewport 1440×1000, locale en-GB, Accept-Language: en-GB,en;q=0.9. Navigation waits for domcontentloaded (45 s cap), then gives networkidle a bounded 2.5 s chance, then a fixed 1.2 s settle. Institutional sites run analytics that never let the network go idle, so the wait is bounded and whatever has rendered is taken. Rendering rather than

plain HTTP matters: several of these landing pages are client-side rendered, and an HTML fetch would see an empty shell and report the node as having no content — a false accusation produced by the tool.

3. **Record status, final URL and redirect chain.** Redirects are captured from response events (first 10 kept).

4. **Extract the evidence** from the rendered DOM (_extract, fetch.py:225). script, style, noscript and template are removed first. Then:

    - full_text — all body text, whitespace-collapsed;
    - main_text — text of the first of main, [role=main], article, #content, .content, falling back to body. Kept separate so a cookie banner or a language switcher cannot sway language detection;
    - links — every a[href] except javascript: and bare #, resolved to absolute URLs; if the anchor has no text, a nested img's alt is used as its label;
    - images — every img (src, alt, aria-label, title, class) plus every svg (its text content as the label);
    - controls — every button, a[href], input[type=submit] and [role=button] that has a label, taken from its text, its aria-label or its value;
    - title, lang_attr (the html element's lang), meta_description.

5. **Screenshot** the viewport (not the full page) to results/evidence/screenshots/<node>.png. Nothing in the assess stage reads the screenshot; it exists for the human reviewer. It captures the visible viewport, not the full page, so it cannot be used to confirm the absence of anything — a footer link is real but off-image.

6. **Depth 1, if requested.** select_children (fetch.py:435) picks which links to follow. A link qualifies only if it is http(s), is not a binary by extension, is on the node's own host or a related host, and its combined link text and URL path matches the vocabulary of a point that a second page can settle. The vocabulary is defined once in patterns.py and consumed by both the crawler and the checks, so the crawler cannot fail to fetch something a check would have accepted.

    The purposes, in the order they consume budget:

Order	Point	Vocabulary
1	5b	Acceptable Use Policy, AUP, terms of use/service, conditions of use, user agreement
2	5c	user access policy, UAP, access policy, conditions of access, access conditions
3	6	helpdesk, help desk, service desk, support, ticket, contact, get in touch
4	2	about, who we are, our mission, mission
5	5p	policy/policies (not privacy, cookie or "policy makers"), legal,

Order	Point	Vocabulary
		terms
6	5s	service/services, catalog/catalogue, resource/resources

Purposes 5p and 5s are not checklist points. They exist because v3.2 accepts the AUP and UAP "via intermediate web pages linked by the NLP": a page fetched for them is read by 5b and 5c for policy links. They come last, so a per-node cap drops them before a link that settles a point, and a link already chosen for another purpose is not tagged with them. They are looked for on the landing page only, never at depth 2: in run web-14 looking for them at the second hop too used the whole fetch budget. A link is excluded from 5p when its label or address mentions privacy or cookies.

Caps: MAX_PER_PURPOSE = 2, MAX_CHILDREN = 8 per node (overridable with --max-children), 1.2 s between child requests. Each child page carries selected_for, the list of points it was fetched for, and every link that was matched but dropped is recorded in children_skipped **with the reason**. That list is the difference between "checked and absent" and "never looked".

Child pages are fetched more cheaply than the landing page: 25 s timeout, 600 ms settle, no networkidle wait, no screenshot.

7. **Depth 2, if requested.** Only from children that rendered — a child that failed has no trustworthy links. Meaner caps: MAX_PER_PURPOSE_D2 = 1, at most 2 grandchildren per child, a run-wide fetch budget of 60, 1.5 s between requests. A URL already fetched for this node is never fetched twice. robots.txt is consulted per host at this level too, cached one fetch per host per run, because following links reaches hosts the landing page never named.

   When depth 2 was used, the assess stage runs **both** the full assessment and an assessment of the same evidence with the second hop stripped (without_depth_2), storing the latter as results_depth_1. The report can then show what the extra requests actually changed instead of asserting they were worth making.

8. **Write** the whole record as JSON.

The whole node is bounded (fetch_with_limit, fetch.py:671). Steps 1 to 7 run under one time limit, --node-timeout, default 300 s (NODE_TIMEOUT_S). If it expires the work is cancelled, given 15 s to close its browser context, and then left behind; the record keeps whatever was gathered, but its error is set to TimeoutError: node collection did not finish within … s, so **every point becomes ERROR**, never a FAIL built on evidence that stopped half-way. The browser is restarted before the next node, in case the stall was the browser's own. The robots.txt reads (steps 1 and 7) run in a worker thread, because a blocking read on the event loop would stop the limit itself from firing. The limit was added on 20 October 2026, after one node's collection stalled in the GitHub run web-29 and held the job until its 30-minute limit.

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3. What the evidence contains — and what it does not

PageEvidence (fetch.py:140) holds: node_id, node_name, requested_url, fetched_at, final_url, http_status, redirect_chain, robots_allowed, robots_note, title, lang_attr, main_text, full_text, links, images, controls, meta_description, error, screenshot, crawl_depth, children, children_skipped, crawl_note.

Image holds only src, alt, aria_label, title, css_class, inline_svg. Link holds href, text, visible. Control holds text, href, tag.

No geometry, visibility or computed style is captured anywhere. getBoundingClientRect, offsetWidth and getComputedStyle do not appear in src/. This is the single most consequential gap in the design, and it is why point 3 can never be closed automatically: the checklist asks whether a logo is *visibly displayed*, and the tool has recorded nothing about visibility. It knows an element exists in the markup. It does not know whether a human would see it.

Likewise, a logo delivered as a CSS background-image, as an SVG sprite reference, or from a file whose name does not contain eosc, is invisible to the tool. Its absence from the evidence is not evidence of absence.

Every string in the evidence is saved with personal data masked (privacy.py, through write_evidence in fetch.py). Personal addresses become XXXXX@domain, phone numbers become +CC XXXXXX, and a name next to a masked address becomes XXXXX. Role mailboxes are kept. The checks therefore run on masked text, which costs nothing: point 6 needs a helpdesk, and no check uses a person's address or number. Re-assessing the 24 September evidence after masking gave the same verdict in all 120 cells, and that run was masked this way at commit ada1b4a. Runs web-4 to web-13, which replaced it as the published run on 26 September, were masked as they were collected. The reports are masked a second time as they are written (write_all in report.py), so a report rebuilt from evidence captured before masking existed is masked too. Screenshots are not masked.

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4. Stage 2 — the assessment machinery

checks.run_all(ev, approved_names, expected_eosc_page) calls exactly ten functions in checklist order and returns exactly ten Result records. The mapping between checklist point ids and check functions is asserted to be total in both directions by the test suite, so a point cannot be silently unassessed and a function cannot assess a point that no longer exists.

A Result carries point_id, title, verdict, message, evidence (a list of strings), and reviewer_action.

The verdict vocabulary

Verdict	Meaning
PASS	Satisfied, and the tool can show why
FAIL	Violated, and the tool can show why
MANUAL_REVIEW	A human must decide; evidence is attached to make that fast
ERROR	The tool could not assess at all (page unreachable, robots disallowed)

MANUAL_REVIEW is the load-bearing one. Several checklist points turn on phrases like "clearly state", or quantify over "all Node Exchange research resources offered by the Node". Neither is settleable by inspecting one page, and emitting PASS or FAIL on them would be a guess dressed as a verdict. A wrong FAIL against a named organisation is expensive to retract, so where the tool cannot know, it says so and hands over the evidence.

The first step of every check

Every one of the ten functions begins the same way:

```
if ev.error:  ->  ERROR
```

So a node whose landing page could not be fetched at all returns ten ERROR cells, never a mix of passes and a failure.

Shared helpers

Helper	Line	What it does
_match(text, patterns)	64	Returns the matched substring for each pattern that hits
_link_hits(ev, patterns)	73	Links whose "{text} {href}" matches any pattern
_fmt(link)	82	Renders a link as "label" -> href for the evidence list
_is_host(netloc, domain)	170	Exact host **or true subdomain**. Rejects myeosc.eu and not-eosc.eu, which a naive endswith would accept
_verify_child(ev, point, ...)	772	The child page that was followed for this point, or None
_policy_check(...)	812	The whole decision procedure shared by points 5b and 5c, with the on_nlp switch for the item 5 rule
render_warning(ev)	—	Reason to distrust *absence of text* on this page
link_collection_warning(ev)	—	Reason to distrust *absence of a link*

The two absence gates — and why there are two

Concluding "absent" from an incomplete capture is the most damaging mistake this kind of tool can make, because the output is an accusation against a named organisation. So absence-based FAILs are gated. But the two kinds of absence need different gates.

render_warning asks *did the page render enough to read?* It fires when a cookie-consent overlay dominates the captured text (consent markers present and main_text under 1200 chars), when fewer than 25 links were captured, or when main_text is under 600 chars. This is the right question for a judgement about prose and the **wrong** question for a link.

link_collection_warning asks only *did the DOM arrive?* It fires when no links at all were captured, when len(links) + len(images) + len(controls) < 10 (DOM_ELEMENT_FLOOR), or when full_text is under 500 chars (EMPTY_DOCUMENT_CHARS). Text length is not evidence about DOM delivery — a small page is not a truncated one.

The distinction came from a real case. One node in this set serves 530 characters of main text behind a cookie banner but 20 anchors — exactly the 20 in the server's HTML, and 21 in the rendered DOM both before and after accepting consent. Gating a link-absence FAIL on text length let a genuinely verified absence escape as "cannot conclude". The absence of an eosc.eu link there is a fact about the node, not an artefact of collection.

Where a FAIL stands despite a render warning, _render_note appends the caveat to the evidence: the verdict is not suppressed, but the reviewer is told a consent banner was in the way so the finding can be spot-checked.

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5. Per-point decision procedures

Ten points, ten functions. For each: the steps taken, the branch conditions in evaluation order, and the verdict each branch yields.

Point 1 — NLP publicly accessible, or reachable via EOSC AAI

check_1. Decided almost entirely on HTTP status.

Steps: read http_status; measure len(full_text); on a 401/403, search full_text for login vocabulary and final_url for AAI markers, then search full_text + title for bot-wall wording.

#	Condition	Verdict
1	error set	ERROR
2	2xx **and** full_text > 200 chars	PASS — branch (a) satisfied
3	401/403 **and** a login affordance found	MANUAL_REVIEW — branch (b) may apply, but whether that login is EOSC AAI cannot be read off the page
4	401/403, no login affordance	MANUAL_REVIEW
5	404 or 410	FAIL — the registered URL does not resolve to a page
6	≥ 500	MANUAL_REVIEW — often transient, not recorded as a failure without a retry
7	any other ≥ 400	MANUAL_REVIEW
8	2xx but ≤ 200 chars	MANUAL_REVIEW — may need JavaScript the tool did not run, or be a shell

Branch 4 deserves its own note, because it looks like it should be a failure and is not. A bare 403 to an automated client is far more often bot mitigation than an access policy — genuine access control almost always redirects to a login. This was not hypothetical: a node in this set served HTTP 200 to the tool and then 403 once the crawl made a handful more requests. Reporting that as "not publicly accessible" would have been the tool blaming a node for its own request rate. The same node returned 200 again hours later to a run from an address that had made no requests that day, settling all four of its review cells — so the abstention was not merely cautious, it was correct, and a FAIL would have stood as a wrong verdict about a named organisation. The evidence records any bot-protection wording found (cloudflare, just a moment, ray id, captcha, …) and the reviewer action is to open the URL in an ordinary browser.

Point 1R — resources behind the landing page are public or behind EOSC AAI

check_1R. **Returns MANUAL_REVIEW unconditionally** (unless error).

Steps:

1. Take the landing page host from final_url.
2. Collect every link whose host differs from it and is not eosc.eu or a subdomain (via _is_host).
3. Group those by host, listing up to 12 hosts with up to 3 distinct link labels each, so the reviewer sees distinct destinations rather than 90 URLs.
4. Search full_text and all hrefs for AAI markers (eosc-aai, aai.eosc, myaccessid, egi check-in, aai.egi.eu, …) and list any found.
5. If depth ≥ 1, report how many followed child pages were served anonymously, and name up to 5 that were not.

The point quantifies over every Node Exchange resource reachable through the landing page, including through intermediate pages, and whether a given login is genuinely EOSC AAI compliant is settled under requirement [P.2] of the Production 1.0 Checklist for EOSC Nodes rather than by reading HTML. A script cannot tell which linked resources are Node Exchange resources either. One level of crawling narrows this; it cannot close it. The output is a worklist, not a verdict.

Point 2 — scope, intended users and responsible organisation stated

check_2. **Returns MANUAL_REVIEW unconditionally** (unless error).

Steps:

1. Take the first 600 characters of main_text, falling back to full_text.
2. Add the meta description if present (first 200 chars).
3. Find organisation-like names by regex: up to four capitalised words followed by a legal-entity or institutional suffix — ERIC, e.V., GmbH, Ltd, Foundation, Institute, Institut, University, Universit[eéà], Consortium, Association, Council, Agency, Centre, Center, CNRS, CNR, CSC. Up to six are listed; if none match, that is stated explicitly.
4. If an About page was followed at depth 1 and rendered, quote its opening 260 characters — **clearly marked as one level down**, because the checklist asks the *landing page* to state these things and an About page cannot satisfy it on the page's behalf.

Whether the prose conveys scope, intended users and the responsible organisation to a researcher is a reading judgement. The check's job is to make that reading take thirty seconds instead of five minutes.

Point 3 — EOSC logo and official node name visible

check_3. **Returns MANUAL_REVIEW on both branches** (unless error).

Steps:

1. For every captured image and inline SVG, build the haystack "{src} {alt} {aria_label} {title} {css_class}" — but with the **host part of src removed**, so a node served from a host containing "eosc" does not match on every locally-hosted image. The path and query survive, so eosc-node-

final.webp still counts. "eosc" must then appear as a token, not inside a longer word: geoscience and neoscope do not match, while the official lockups EOSCNode_Finland.jpg and EOSCNodeBBMRIERIC_ColourPos.png do, because CamelCase is treated as a word break. Separately, an asset genuinely served from eosc.eu counts via a host check, so a cross-host node logo — correct behaviour — is still found, while myeosc.eu is not.

2. For each hit, record the kind (img or inline SVG) and a label, preferring alt, then aria_label, then title, then the filename.
3. Take the names that apply to *this* node — those written as node-id: Name, then any unscoped ones — and test each against full_text in file order. The list is checklist/approved-names.txt unless --approved-names replaces it or --no-approved-names suppresses it. Each word of a name is matched literally and case-insensitively, and never inside a longer word or hyphenated token; the separator *between* words is flexible, so whitespace and the glyphs |, -, –, —, :, /, · are interchangeable — unless --strict-separators is passed, which restores literal glyph matching (and is recorded in the output, so a reader knows which rule was in force). Record the first match, what the page actually wrote, and whether the name was scoped to this node. If the body is empty (a 403, say), record that the name was not looked for rather than that it is absent. If nothing matched, also record how many times the longest leading phrase shared by all the candidate names — EOSC Node, for the official list — occurs in the body, so the reviewer knows whether there is anything to look at.

#	Condition	Verdict
1	At least one EOSC-referencing image asset	MANUAL_REVIEW — the logo requirement is *likely* met
2	None	MANUAL_REVIEW — explicitly **not** proof of absence

Neither branch can be closed, for two separate reasons that are worth keeping apart:

- **A missing capability.** "Clearly and visibly shown" is a question about rendered geometry, and section 3 explains that no geometry was captured. This is not a judgement call the tool declines to make; it is data the tool does not have.
- **A name the tool can check, against a list it cannot validate.** The official Tripartite list is now committed at checklist/approved-names.txt and used by default, so the name half *is* assessed — but the tool cannot tell whether that file is current, and a non-match may mean the page is wrong, the name is in an image, or the list is stale. results.json records which list was in force under approved_names, including whether it was the committed default, and both reports state it in prose, so a REVIEW here cannot be misread as a checked-and-clean name. --no-approved-names skips the half entirely, and the reports say that too.
- **A weaker claim from an unscoped list.** A name given without a node-id: prefix applies to every node, so a match shows the string is on the page but not that it is that node's own name. The evidence line says which of the two claims it is making. Scoping each name to its node is what makes the stronger claim available, and checklist/approved-names-scoped.txt does exactly that. It is deliberately not the default: the names in it are official, but the mapping from each name to a node id in nodes.yaml was derived here and is not part of the Tripartite file, so that mapping is what a reviewer should challenge first.

Branch 1 used to over-match badly; the history is in section 6.

Point 4 — link to the node's own page on eosc.eu

check_4. The point that produces most of the FAILs in practice: all 6 in the published run of 24 September 2026, and 6 of the 7 in the run of 21 September, the seventh being point 6 for a node with no contact route of any kind on its landing page.

Steps: for every link, parse the URL; keep only those whose host is eosc.eu or a true subdomain (_is_host, so myeosc.eu does not qualify); strip the trailing slash from the path; sort into three buckets —

- **node_pages** — path contains building-the-eosc-federation *and* has a non-empty tail after it;
- **index_only** — path contains building-the-eosc-federation with nothing after it;
- **other_eosc** — any other eosc.eu link.

#	Condition	Verdict
1	node_pages non-empty	PASS (up to 3 links quoted)
2	index_only non-empty	FAIL — the index is explicitly excluded by the checklist
3	other_eosc non-empty	FAIL — links to eosc.eu but not to the dedicated page; the homepage is excluded
4	none, and link_collection_warning fires	MANUAL_REVIEW — too little captured to conclude absence
5	none, DOM complete	FAIL — no link to eosc.eu found, with any render caveat appended

When nodes.yaml records the node's eosc_page, that URL is passed in as expected_page and appended to the evidence of branches 2, 3, 4 and 5 as "the node's dedicated page exists at … but is not linked from here". Naming the exact page turns "something is absent" into a one-line fix the node operator can action.

What a PASS here does not establish. Three things, all of which a reviewer should know before quoting one:

- **The target is never requested.** The check matches the URL's *shape* — host, path prefix, non-empty tail. A link to a node page that has since been deleted would PASS identically. Confirming the destination is a manual step.
- **Placement is not recorded.** A link in the footer and a link in the body are indistinguishable in the evidence. The checklist requires a link and says nothing about prominence, so footer placement is compliant — but the evidence cannot tell you which you are looking at. EUDAT's link, for instance, is the fourth item in a "Navigation & Legal" footer column, 89% of the way down the page.
- **The screenshot cannot corroborate it.** Captures are viewport-only (full_page=False in fetch.py), so anything below the fold — which includes every footer link — is absent from the saved image. A reviewer checking a PASS against the screenshot may conclude the tool invented the link. This has happened.

Which item 5 rule applies

Item 5 changed in checklist v3.2 (28 September 2026). Under v3.0 and v3.1 the purpose description, the AUP and the UAP had to be accessible in English "either directly or via the link to the resource's entry in the EOSC Catalogue". Under v3.2 they must be accessible "both on the NLP presenting the resource to the users (directly on the NLP itself or via intermediate web pages linked by the NLP) and via the link to the resource's

entry in the EOSC Catalogue", which the document spells out as: present "for each resource in the EOSC Exchange, both on the NLP itself (or on pages linked by the NLP web page) and in the Metadata about the Resource in the Node Catalogue". This is the wording of v3.2 as re-issued on 29 September 2026; the first copy said "directly on the NLP" only, and is discarded.

check_5a, check_5b and check_5c take a switch, on_nlp. run_all passes it as item5_on_nlp, and the CLI reads it from the checklist file: checklist/v3.2.yaml declares item5_on_nlp: true; v3.0.yaml and v3.1.yaml do not declare it, which the CLI reads as false. So rebuilding a run with -c checklist/v3.1.yaml applies the v3.1 rule, and reproduces that run exactly. The functions default to True, the rule of the default checklist.

The tool reads the landing page and, one level down, the pages it links to. It never reads the EOSC Catalogue. Under v3.2 that means it can check only the NLP half of item 5, and every 5a–5c result says so.

Point 5a — purpose description for research resources

check_5a. **Returns MANUAL_REVIEW unconditionally** (unless error), under either rule.

The evidence is two numbers: the count of outbound links, and the length of main_text. The point quantifies over "all Node Exchange research resources offered by the Node", which cannot be enumerated from the landing page, and judging whether a description states a purpose is reading. Under v3.1 the message adds that the description may live in the Catalogue entry instead; under v3.2 it says the description must be both on the NLP (directly or on a page it links to) and in the Catalogue metadata, and the reviewer action asks for both. There is no branch on which the tool could honestly resolve it, so it does not pretend to.

Points 5b and 5c — AUP and UAP accessible

check_5b and check_5c both delegate to _policy_check with different vocabularies. Identical procedure, so it is described once. Each also receives the *other* point's vocabulary, which the v3.2 rule uses: 5b looks for a UAP link, and 5c for an AUP link, when its own is missing.

Steps:

1. _link_hits — links whose label or address matches the policy vocabulary. The address is read twice, raw and with its separators turned into spaces (patterns.link_haystack), so /geant-node-acceptable-use-policy/ matches acceptable\s+use\s+polic. The crawler selects links with the same function.
2. _match on full_text — mentions of the vocabulary in the prose.
3. If links were found, look for the child page fetched for this point.

Branches 1–5 are the same under both rules:

#	Condition	Verdict
1	Link found, **no child fetched**	PASS, stated as "a pointer, not a verified document", with the reason: depth 0, a PDF or other document, a cap reached, another site, or not selected at collection
2	Link found, child returned 404/410	FAIL — the policy is not accessible; but if the page has other links to the policy, pointing

#	Condition	Verdict
		elsewhere, branch 1 applies to them and the evidence reports the broken one
3	Link found, child not ok for another reason	MANUAL_REVIEW — may be a bot restriction rather than a real problem
4	Child fetched, but main_text < 400 chars **or** no policy wording	MANUAL_REVIEW — reads like a navigation stub, not a policy
5	Child fetched, substantial, policy wording present	PASS

Under v3.2, the reviewer action of a PASS (branches 1 and 5) adds that the policy must also be in each resource's Catalogue metadata, which the tool does not read: a PASS settles the NLP half only.

When no link to the point's own policy was found, the rules differ.

Checklist v3.0 and v3.1 (on_nlp false):

#	Condition	Verdict
6	No link, but the vocabulary appears in the page text	MANUAL_REVIEW — mentioned but not followable
7	Nothing at all	MANUAL_REVIEW — **deliberately not a FAIL**: the policy could be in the Catalogue

Checklist v3.2 (on_nlp true), in this order. "Linked pages read" are the child pages (depth 1 and 2) that returned 2xx, whatever purpose they were fetched for:

#	Condition	Verdict
6a	A linked page read links to the policy (or is itself titled as the policy and reads like one), and every such link that was fetched is broken, with no other left	FAIL — the policy is not accessible
6b	A linked page read links to the policy (or is itself the policy)	PASS — "via intermediate web pages linked by the NLP"; the evidence names the intermediate page, and the message says whether the policy page itself was fetched
7	The landing page or a linked page read links to the **other** policy (a UAP for 5b, an AUP for 5c)	MANUAL_REVIEW — "AUP and UAP can be provided through the same, single document"
8	The landing page links to a **licence** (LICENCE_PATTERNS: licence/license, licensing, Creative Commons, CC BY)	MANUAL_REVIEW — "AUP/UAP can be provided via specific product licenses in the case of datasets, archives, software"

#	Condition	Verdict
9	link_collection_warning fires: no links, fewer than 10 DOM elements, or under 500 characters of text	MANUAL_REVIEW — the DOM did not arrive, so absence is not concluded (the same gate as point 4)
10	The landing page links, on its own site, to a policies, legal, terms, services, catalogue or resources page (POLICY_INDEX_PATTERNS, SERVICE_INDEX_PATTERNS) that was **not read**	MANUAL_REVIEW — the pointers may be there; the evidence lists up to three such links as "not read"
11	Otherwise	**FAIL** — no pointer on the landing page nor on any linked page read, and no candidate page left unread. If the page names the policy in its text without a link, the message says so and the mention is kept in the evidence, but it is still a FAIL: naming a document does not make it accessible

Branch 10 is what keeps the new rule honest. The checklist accepts any page the NLP links to, and the tool reads at most eight; a FAIL asserts that the policy is nowhere the tool could reasonably look, so an unread policies or services page makes it review. Pages on other sites are not candidates, as for the crawl.

Branch 1 is weaker than it looks, and the message says so: a link labelled "Acceptable Use Policy" pointing at a 404 satisfies "there is a link" while failing the actual requirement, which is that the policy be *accessible*. Running at --depth 1 converts branch 1 into one of branches 2–5 for ordinary pages on the node's own site. It cannot do so for a PDF or a page on another site, and the reviewer action says so rather than suggesting a re-run that would not help.

Branches 2 and 6a fail only when the broken link is the only way to the policy (since 1 October 2026, commit 1418f05). EOSC Node Italy linked "Infrastructure AUP/UAP" to a working policy page and "Review resource access conditions" to a 404; the tool followed the second and had failed 5c, though the policy was linked. A broken link next to a working one is a defect to report, not an absence.

Branch 4's "policy wording" test is POLICY_BODY_PATTERNS: must not, you may/must/shall/agree, permitted, prohibit, terms, policy, conditions, responsib, comply, authorised, authorized. It exists to tell a real policy document apart from a navigation page that merely has the word "policy" in its link text.

Under v3.1, branch 7 was not a FAIL because the checklist permitted the policy to be reached via each resource's entry in the EOSC Catalogue alone. v3.2 removed that alternative, so the same absence is now a FAIL (v3.2 branch 11). The exceptions in v3.2 branches 7 and 8 come from the checklist's own notes; they lead to review, never to PASS, because a UAP is not proof of an AUP and a licence is not proof of either. "AUP and UAP do not necessarily need to be unique per service" is why a single policy linked from the NLP, or from a page it links to, satisfies the NLP half for every resource: the tool does not ask for one link per resource.

What the rule changed on the published evidence. Under the first copy of v3.2 ("directly on the NLP"), 5b and 5c moved from MANUAL_REVIEW to FAIL for CERN, Data Terra and PaNOSC, whose landing pages link to neither policy nor a licence; runs web-12 and web-13 confirmed it. Under the re-issued v3.2 (web-13 re-

scored as web-13-rescored, without contacting any node), those six cells are review again, now by branch 10: each landing page links to a services or policies page that web-13 did not read (CERN's "Services" and "Policies", for instance). BBMRI-ERIC's 5b moved from review to PASS by branch 6b: its Access Policies page links the "Acceptable Use Policy of BBMRI-ERIC Services". Every other cell is unchanged: seven nodes link one of the two policies and get review on the other (branch 7), Slovakia links one document labelled as both, and GÉANT's page was not served (branch 9). Run web-14, the first collection under the re-issued v3.2, read those pages: CERN's 5b and 5c pass by branch 6b (its "Policies" page links both policies, which were fetched), Data Terra's fail by branch 11 (its two services pages were read and link neither; they are in French, which the English vocabulary does not cover), and PaNOSC's stay review by branch 10 (its services site was not read). Run web-15, with the second hop no longer looking for services pages, kept all three, and so did web-16 and web-18. In web-21 Data Terra was read at its new address, www.earth-data.eu, which links an AUP: 5b passes by branch 1 and 5c is review by branch 7. In web-22 PaNOSC links "Acceptable User Policy and User Access Policy" to a user-policies page: 5c passes by branch 5, and 5b is review by branch 7, because "Acceptable User Policy" does not match the AUP vocabulary.

Point 6 — means of contacting the node helpdesk

check_6. Two tiers: wording that identifies a helpdesk, then general contact vocabulary. The word "support" on its own is only a reason to follow a link. On 24 September 2026 it labelled a funding programme (Czechia), a EuroHPC proposal service (on the page of a node that was listed by mistake and was replaced by EOSC Node Poland on 28 September 2026) and a service overview (BBMRI-ERIC), and all three had passed.

Steps:

1. Collect mailto: links.
2. _link_hits with the full contact vocabulary.
3. From those two sets, keep the ones that **identify a helpdesk**. That means the label or address matches HELPDESK_STRONG (helpdesk, service desk, ticket, a support team, request or portal, user/technical support, contact/ask/get support, a support@ or support[at] address, ServiceNow). A host whose first label is hd, support or helpdesk also counts, and so does a mailbox such as support@, helpdesk@, x-helpdesk@ or x@helpdesk.....
4. Otherwise read **every** page followed for point 6, not only the first. A page counts if it matches HELPDESK_ON_PAGE (helpdesk, service desk, ticket, a support address, ServiceNow) or gives a helpdesk mailbox. Qualified "support" phrases are strong in a link label, but not in page prose: they describe services there.

#	Condition	Verdict
1	Landing-page link or mailto that identifies a helpdesk	PASS
2	Contact or bare "support" link, a followed page names a helpdesk or gives a helpdesk mailbox	PASS — quoting the wording and the addresses
3	Contact or bare "support" link, followed pages ok, none identifies a helpdesk	MANUAL_REVIEW — says when a "support" label was the only lead, and lists addresses and links not followed
4	Every followed page returned 404/410	FAIL — the route offered does not work

#	Condition	Verdict
5	Generic contact link, nothing further established	MANUAL_REVIEW
6	No contact route, link_collection_warning fires	MANUAL_REVIEW
7	No contact route, DOM complete	FAIL — no mailto:, no link labelled or addressed as contact, support or helpdesk

Branches 2 and 3 are why depth 1 is worth the requests here. A "Contact" link is ambiguous on its own; the page behind it usually is not — it either names a helpdesk and offers a form or an address, or it does not. One request settles what keyword matching cannot.

Point 7 — the page is in English

check_7. The only point using statistical detection rather than pattern matching.

Steps:

1. Take main_text, falling back to full_text. Read the declared lang attribute.
2. If under 120 characters → MANUAL_REVIEW, too little to detect a language.
3. Build a lingua detector over all Latin-script languages, take the first 4000 characters, and record the top language and its confidence.

#	Detected	Declared	Verdict
1	en	en*	PASS
2	en	anything else	PASS — the mismatch is a metadata inconsistency worth fixing, but it does not breach point 7
3	not en	en*	MANUAL_REVIEW — mixed-language pages and navigation-heavy text both cause this
4	not en	not en*	FAIL

If lingua is not installed, the check degrades rather than crashing: a declared en gives PASS noting that detection was unavailable, anything else gives MANUAL_REVIEW.

Separating main_text from full_text matters most here. A cookie banner or a language switcher listing eight languages in the page chrome is exactly the kind of text that misleads a detector, and it is excluded by construction.

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6. Where this workflow is known to be wrong

Listed because a checker whose limitations are undocumented invites more trust than it has earned.

Point 3 over-matched on the page's own hostname — fixed, and the first diagnosis of it was wrong. The haystack included img.src in full, so for a node served from a host containing "eosc" the regex matched the *hostname of every locally-hosted image*. The run of 21 September 2026 reported 8 "EOSC-referencing image assets" for that node; probing the captured evidence showed **7 of the 8 matched on the hostname alone** — a favicon counted three times, a parallax background, a gateway logo, a partner logo, and an EU funding badge named FundedbytheEU.png. None is an EOSC logo. Exactly one was real.

This document previously recorded the cause as cross-host loading and proposed restricting the host. That was the wrong fix, and probing the evidence before applying it is what showed why: several nodes legitimately serve their EOSC lockup from a CDN or their own domain (i0.wp.com, research.csc.fi, portal.eudat.eu, www.panosc.eu), so a host restriction would have discarded genuine logos. The defect was never cross-host loading; it was the node's *own* host being part of the text being searched.

The fix strips the host from src and requires "eosc" to be a token rather than a substring, with an explicit allowance for eosc.eu-hosted assets. Re-running against the same evidence moved that node from 8 assets to 1 and left all eight other nodes untouched. **No verdict changed** — the branch returns MANUAL_REVIEW either way — and the tally is still 28 PASS / 7 FAIL / 55 review; what changed is that the evidence line no longer pushes a reviewer towards the wrong conclusion.

The boundary rule then had a defect of its own, found by regenerating the report rather than by reasoning about it: requiring a non-word character *after* "eosc" rejected EOSCNode_Finland-1-1-scaled.jpg, which is the official lockup, and cost the Finnish node its only EOSC asset — flipping its point 3 evidence from "asset present" to "none found". An uppercase letter is now accepted as a word break. The leading guard is still strict, which is what keeps geoscience and GEOSCIENCE out.

The approved-name match over-matched, then under-matched. Both are recorded because both shipped. First, the name was matched as a bare substring of the page body, so a short name matched inside ordinary words: EGI in the list reported a match on the BBMRI-ERIC page (inside "strat**egi**c") and on Data Terra (inside "Norw**egi**an"), neither of which names the EGI node. The list was also matched as a whole, so any name matching any page satisfied that page's evidence line. Matching was made boundary-aware and scopable with a node-id: prefix.

That fix was then too strict. Run against the official Tripartite list, which writes every name as EOSC Node | X, it matched **none of the nine pages**: the pages disagree about the separator glyph, not the name — BBMRI-ERIC writes a hyphen and an en dash, European DTO the pipe, EUDAT nothing at all. Publishing that would have been a finding against every node for a typographic difference. Separator glyphs are now interchangeable, and the evidence quotes what the page wrote so the variant is visible. This is a deliberate loosening, so it is reversible rather than baked in: --strict-separators restores the literal rule and reproduces the 0-of-9 result, and the report states which rule was in force either way. The place to challenge the default is the table in the guide.

The match is still not proof of the right name. The committed list is unscoped, so a match says the string is on the page, not that it is that page's own name; and with 9 names applying to all 9 nodes, a page carrying a *different* node's approved name would satisfy its own evidence line. The line says which claim it is making. Scoping the list is what makes the stronger claim available, and checklist/approved-names-scoped.txt now does. Run against the same evidence it returns the same two nodes, BBMRI-ERIC and EUDAT, which retires the concern for this dataset: the 2-of-9 headline does not depend on names leaking between pages. The published run of 24 September confirms it on twelve nodes: both lists match the same five (BBMRI-ERIC,

Czechia, EUDAT, GÉANT, Slovakia), and --strict-separators matches none. The published runs of 26 and 28 September give the same agreement on thirteen: both lists match four (GÉANT's page was blocked both days), and --strict-separators matches none. The residual weakness is no longer the matching but the mapping — name to node id — which was derived in this repository rather than taken from the Tripartite file.

No verdict changed at any point, because the name never decides point 3 — but the evidence line did, twice, and both times it was wrong.

Nothing about visibility is captured, as set out in section 3. Point 3 cannot be closed automatically under the current evidence model, regardless of how the matching is fixed.

The vocabularies are English-only. A node serving a Dutch or Finnish contact page will be missed by points 5b, 5c and 6. Point 7 requires the landing page to be in English, so the bias is tolerable for this checklist — but it is a bias, not a neutral default.

A legitimate cross-host logo is indistinguishable from an unrelated one. At least one node in this set loads its node logo from eosc.eu while being served from its own domain, which is correct behaviour. A host check alone would need care not to reject it.

Binary policy documents are never read. select_children skips URLs ending in a binary extension, so an AUP published as a PDF is recorded as a pointer (branch 1 of _policy_check) and never verified. The checklist's requirement is accessibility, and the tool cannot confirm it for these.

--only used to narrow the run in place — fixed, with a cost. Assessing a subset rewrote the shared report, so a one-node table replaced the full one and looked complete. --only now narrows only which sites are fetched; the report written to the default results directory still covers every node, and the requested subset is recorded in a top-level selection list. An explicit --results DIR keeps the old narrowing, where nothing shared is at risk.

The cost is that such a report is no longer uniformly fresh: unselected rows come from evidence already on disk, under a header stating a single run timestamp. That is a freshness claim the report cannot make, so it no longer makes it — a **Mixed freshness** banner in both the Markdown and HTML output names what was re-fetched, counts what was not, and gives the capture date of the reused evidence. Nodes with no evidence at all are still listed under missing_evidence, printed in red, with exit code 2.

The row heading comes from nodes.yaml, not from the evidence. assess labels each node with the url configured now, while every verdict comes from the evidence captured then. After BBMRI-ERIC's URL changed on 25 September, a bare assess headed its row with the new dev3. address above verdicts taken from the old www. page. The address really fetched is kept only as final_url, in the evidence and in the fetch summary of results.json. Until the tool compares the two, rebuild an old run with the node list it was collected with (--nodes); the run guide gives the exact command.

A public CI summary is not the place for per-node verdicts. The workflow used to copy the whole of results.md into $GITHUB_STEP_SUMMARY, which on a public repository is world-readable. The verdicts are already public — the report is committed — so nothing leaked that was not already published; but that page is produced automatically from an unreviewed run and carries the repository's name, which makes a table of FAILs against named organisations read as a finding rather than a draft. The summary now publishes counts only, labelled as unreviewed, and points at the artifact for the per-node detail. It also refuses to summarise at all unless the check step succeeded, because results.json is committed and would otherwise have been read out of a fresh checkout as though it were this run's result.

---

7. Reading the output

results.json carries run_id, generated_at, the full checklist as loaded, approved_names (whether a list was used, whether it was the committed default (default_used), whether it was scoped, how many names, its path, the sha256 of the bytes actually read, and strict_separators — plus the older approved_names_supplied flag, kept for readers of earlier result files), selection (the node ids --only restricted the fetch to, empty on a full run), skipped (the node ids --skip left out, empty when nothing was skipped), url_mismatch (present only when some node's evidence was collected from a URL other than the one now configured: id, configured_url, evidence_url, fetched_at; the reports then carry an "Evidence from a different URL" banner), and nodes. Each node carries id, name, url, ad_hoc, a fetch summary (status, final URL, robots note, screenshot, crawl depth, every child with its selected_for and outcome, and children_skipped), results, and results_depth_1 when depth 2 was used.

The same run is rendered to index.html (the matrix, with evidence expandable per cell), results.md, results.csv, and checklist-v3.2.html (named after the revision applied, so checklist-v3.3.html after a future switch; the checklist itself, so a reader can see the rule a verdict was derived from without opening the source document).

The honest summary of the whole workflow: of the ten points, **two** (1 and 4) are routinely settled by inspection, **three** (5b, 5c, 6) are settled when depth 1 gives the tool a second page to read (and, since v3.2, 5b and 5c also fail when the landing page links to no policy at all), and **five** (1R, 2, 3, 5a, and 7 in its mixed-language branch) end in a human's hands by design. A tool that returned PASS or FAIL on every line would look more useful and be worth considerably less.

8. Worked examples

Three step-by-step procedures, one for each change that comes up most often: adding a node, changing a node's URL, and adopting a new revision of the checklist. Each lists which files to edit, the exact commands, and how to put the result into the published results/ directory.

Four rules apply to all three:

- **Try it in a scratch folder first.** --results /tmp/trial writes nowhere near results/, so nothing published changes until you decide it should.
- **Run `uv run pytest -q` after every edit.** It needs no network, takes a few seconds, and names the file you got wrong.
- **Contact as few sites as possible.** Only collect and run send requests. assess works on saved evidence, so it can be repeated as often as you like.
- **A new published run needs a human review before it is committed.** The tool's verdicts are not a compliance statement (see "Reading the output" in the run guide). Write the review down, as results/REVIEW-2026-09-24.md does for the 24 September run, and commit only then.

In terms of the three stages in section 1: examples 1 and 2 need **stage 1** (collection) again, but only for the one node concerned. Example 3 changes **stage 2** (the rules), so it can be tried on the evidence already collected, without contacting any site. Stage 3 (the reports) is always regenerated by assess.

The run labels below (live-2026-10-01-…) are examples. Use the date of your own run.

Example 1 — adding a node and publishing it

The example adds a node with the placeholder id eosc-example. Replace every value with the real ones.

Step 1: edit three files. All three are at the repository root or in checklist/, and all are edited by hand.

nodes.yaml: add the entry. url is the landing page as registered in the EOSC EU Node Contributors Dashboard ("Website address", section 1.2, field 6). Copy eosc_page from the federation index; do not guess it.

```
- id: eosc-example
  name: EOSC Node Example
  url: https://eosc-node.example.org/
  eosc_page: https://eosc.eu/building-the-eosc-federation/eosc-node-example/
```

checklist/approved-names.txt: add the approved name exactly as the Tripartite list writes it:

```
EOSC Node | Example
```

checklist/approved-names-scoped.txt: add the same name, with the node id in front:

```
eosc-example: EOSC Node | Example
```

If the Tripartite list does not include the node yet, do not make a name up. Leave both name files alone. test_nodes.py::test_every_node_has_a_scoped_approved_name then fails and names the node, which is intended: the node is not ready to be published. In the meantime, check it in a scratch folder with --url https://eosc-node.example.org/ (see "Checking a page not in nodes.yaml" in the run guide), which needs no configuration.

Step 2: check the configuration, offline.

```
uv run pytest -q
```

A missing scoped name, an id that is not a valid filename, a URL that is not https, an eosc_page outside eosc.eu, or a landing page already used by another node each fail with a message naming the problem.

Step 3: trial run for the new node only. This contacts one site.

```
uv run basic-check collect --only eosc-example --results /tmp/trial
uv run basic-check assess  --only eosc-example --results /tmp/trial
uv run basic-check show eosc-example --results /tmp/trial
```

Open /tmp/trial/index.html or /tmp/trial/results.md and read the new row. If the page returned ERROR (robots.txt, a 403, a DNS failure), stop there. An ERROR row is not a result worth publishing.

Step 4: put the node into the published run. There are two ways.

A — add the one node to the current run (one site contacted, and already done). Reuse the evidence from step 3 rather than fetching the page again:

```
cp /tmp/trial/evidence/eosc-example.json results/evidence/
cp /tmp/trial/evidence/screenshots/eosc-example.png results/evidence/screenshots/
uv run basic-check assess --only eosc-example --skip Italy \
  --run live-2026-10-01-plus-eosc-example
```

The report covers every node. A **Mixed freshness** banner says that only eosc-example is new and that the other rows are reused from the earlier capture, with its date. The published run includes Italy, read at https://eosc.it/ since 1 October 2026, so no --skip is needed; skip a node only while a trial collection (collect --only <id> --results /tmp/trial) shows its page does not load.

B — a complete new run (every node contacted once). Use this when the existing evidence is old enough that a single timestamp is worth more than leaving the other sites alone:

```
uv run basic-check run --skip Italy --results /tmp/new-run --run live-2026-10-01
# review /tmp/new-run/results.md and index.html, then:
rm -rf results/evidence
cp -r /tmp/new-run/evidence results/evidence
uv run basic-check assess --skip Italy --run live-2026-10-01
```

The last command re-renders the reports in results/ from the evidence you reviewed. It makes no requests.

Either way, assess must end with **exit code 0**. Exit 2 means a configured node has no evidence, so the table is incomplete.

> **If assess warns "Evidence from a different URL".** It means a node's URL in nodes.yaml is not the page its evidence was collected from. That is the case for BBMRI-ERIC from 25 to 26 September 2026, when nodes.yaml had the dev3. address but the published evidence was from the www. one. The warning also appears as a banner in both reports. Either collect that node again first (example 2), or assess with the node list the evidence was collected with, plus the new entry:

```
git show 53081f6:nodes.yaml > /tmp/nodes-published.yaml
# append the eosc-example entry from step 1 to /tmp/nodes-published.yaml
uv run basic-check assess --nodes /tmp/nodes-published.yaml --only eosc-example \
  --skip Italy --run live-2026-10-01-plus-eosc-example
```

Step 5: re-run the tests against the new published run.

```
uv run pytest -q
```

Two tests read the committed evidence. Each exists to make a change visible, not to be satisfied mechanically:

- test_privacy.py::test_the_committed_evidence_publishes_no_personal_address_or_phone must pass as it stands. If it fails, personal data is about to be published. Stop and find out why; never change the test to let it through.
- test_names.py::test_the_official_names_match_the_nodes_that_show_them pins which nodes display their approved name (four for the 26 September run; five on 24 September, when GÉANT's page was served). If the new page shows its name, add its id to the expected set and update the docstring to say why.
- test_update_row.py::test_published_results_are_the_run_these_tests_copy pins how many nodes the run has and which were skipped (13 and none, for run web-13). Update it to the new run's shape.

Step 6: update what quotes the published figures, then commit. results/ is regenerated, but these are written by hand:

- a review document for the new run, like results/REVIEW-2026-09-24.md;
- the headline tally in README.md ("130 cells: 69 PASS · 0 FAIL · 61 review");
- "The published figures" in docs/TEST-SUITE.md, and the node list in "The node list — a YAML file" in the same file.

```
git status
git add nodes.yaml checklist/approved-names.txt checklist/approved-names-scoped.txt \
    results README.md docs tests
git commit -m "Add eosc-example; publish run live-2026-10-01-plus-eosc-example"
git push
```

Example 2 — changing a node's landing page URL

The example is the change actually made on 25 September 2026: BBMRI-ERIC moved from https://www.bbmri-eric.eu/eosc-node-bbmri-eric/ to https://dev3.bbmri-eric.eu/eosc-node-bbmri-eric/. It was set back on 26 September, because the dev3. host's robots.txt excludes the checker, so nodes.yaml has the www. address again.

Which files change. One line in one file: url for that node in nodes.yaml. Nothing else in the repository stores a node's URL. Add a comment recording the old address and the date, so the published evidence can still be traced. --update-nlp makes both edits and changes nothing else (it contacts no site and commits nothing):

```
uv run basic-check --update-nlp bbmri-eric https://new.example.org/eosc-node/
```

To go back, uv run basic-check --restore-default-config puts nodes.yaml back as it was downloaded from GitHub and keeps the replaced file as nodes.yaml.<date-time>.bak.

Done by hand, the entry looks like this:

```
- id: bbmri-eric
  name: BBMRI-ERIC
  # URL changed on 25 September 2026, from
  # https://www.bbmri-eric.eu/eosc-node-bbmri-eric/
  url: https://dev3.bbmri-eric.eu/eosc-node-bbmri-eric/
  eosc_page: https://eosc.eu/building-the-eosc-federation/eosc-node-bbmri-eric/
```

Change eosc_page as well only if the node's own entry on eosc.eu moved; a new landing page does not usually mean a new eosc.eu entry. The name files change only if the node's approved name changed. Keep the id: it names the evidence file, and changing it would make the node look new.

Step 1: check the configuration.

```
uv run pytest -q
```

Step 2: trial run for that node only. This contacts one site.

```
uv run basic-check collect --only bbmri-eric --results /tmp/trial
uv run basic-check assess  --only bbmri-eric --results /tmp/trial
uv run basic-check show bbmri-eric --results /tmp/trial
```

Check that the page actually loaded before going further. On 25 September the dev3. host's robots.txt disallowed every path, the tool honoured it, and all ten points were ERROR. A result like that is not worth publishing: ask the node for its public address, or for the checker to be allowed, and stop there.

Step 3: update that node's row in the published run. Only BBMRI-ERIC is fetched again; the other rows are copied from results/results.json as they are, neither re-fetched nor re-judged:

```
uv run basic-check run --update-results-for-node bbmri-eric
```

That fetches the one page into a scratch directory, and only if the page loaded does it replace bbmri-eric's evidence, screenshot and row, then rebuild results.md, index.html and results.csv from the stored rows. A failed fetch changes nothing (add --accept-error to record it anyway). It prints each point's old and new verdict, and both reports gain an **Updated rows** banner naming the node, the date and the previous URL. The run id and time in the header stay those of the original run. To reuse the evidence from step 2 instead of fetching again, copy it into results/evidence/ and run uv run basic-check assess --update-results-for-node bbmri-eric, which is offline. To see the outcome before touching the published run, try it on a copy first: cp -r

results /tmp/copy and add --results /tmp/copy. For a completely fresh table instead, follow path B of example 1 step 4.

Why the order matters. assess labels each row with the URL in nodes.yaml, but takes the verdicts from the evidence on disk. Between step 1 and step 3, the two describe different pages. assess now detects this. It prints a warning naming the node and both URLs, puts an **Evidence from a different URL** banner in results.md and index.html, and records the pair under url_mismatch in results.json. Step 3 clears it, because the evidence now comes from the configured URL.

To rebuild a run collected with an older node list, without the warning, use that list. For the reviewed run of 24 September (in the git history at 800d632), assessed in a scratch copy of its results/:

```
git show 53081f6:nodes.yaml > /tmp/nodes-2026-09-24.yaml
uv run basic-check assess --run live-2026-09-24-no-italy --skip Italy \
  --nodes /tmp/nodes-2026-09-24.yaml
```

Step 4: tests, review, commit. As in example 1, steps 5 and 6: run uv run pytest -q, check the two tests that read the committed evidence, write the review, update the quoted figures, and commit nodes.yaml, results/ and the documents together.

Example 3 — moving to a new revision of the checklist

There is no URL to change. The tool never downloads the checklist document. A copy of it is committed in checklist/, and three things connect the tool to it:

Where	What it says
src/basic_check/cli.py, the line DEFAULT_CHECKLIST = ROOT / "checklist" / "v3.2.yaml"	Which checklist revision is used when --checklist is not given. **This is the one line to change** to make a new revision the default. The help texts, the tests and the reports all follow it.
checklist/vX.Y.yaml: checklist_version, checklist_date, source_document, source_file, source_sha256	Which document that revision was transcribed from, and its SHA-256 hash.
--checklist / -c <file> on assess, run and points	A different revision for a single run, without changing the default.

When the originating document changes, you therefore add a new file for the new revision and point the default at it. v3.2.yaml is never edited: the published reports name the file they were produced from.

The example assumes a v3.3 dated 15 October 2026. Use the real version, date and filenames. This procedure was last applied on 29 September 2026, to move from v3.1 to v3.2 (and before that on 26 September, from v3.0 to v3.1); the header of checklist/v3.2.yaml records what changed, point by point.

Step 1: commit the new document next to the old one.

```
cp ~/Downloads/20261015_Node_Landing_Page_Verification_Checklist_v3.3.pdf checklist/
sha256sum checklist/20261015_Node_Landing_Page_Verification_Checklist_v3.3.pdf
# on macOS: shasum -a 256 checklist/20261015_Node_Landing_Page_Verification_Checklist_v3.3.pdf
```

The committed v3.2 file is a PDF rendering of the circulated .docx. Commit the .docx itself if you prefer: source_file may name either.

Step 2: create the new revision's file from the old one.

```
cp checklist/v3.2.yaml checklist/v3.3.yaml
```

In checklist/v3.3.yaml, change the header:

```
checklist_version: "3.3"
checklist_date: "2026-10-15"
source_document: 20261015_Node_Landing_Page_Verification_Checklist_v3.3.docx
source_file: 20261015_Node_Landing_Page_Verification_Checklist_v3.3.pdf
source_sha256: <the hash printed in step 1>
```

The version must match the filename (v3.3.yaml declares "3.3"); a test enforces this.

Step 3: compare every point with the new document. No tool can do this step for you. For each point in v3.3.yaml:

- If the wording changed, update title and requirement, which are quoted word for word. Then read the check_* function named in implemented_by, in src/basic_check/checks.py, and change it if it no longer applies the new wording.
- If what a script can decide changed, update decidable and decidable_note.
- Where a rule changed, update that point's decision procedure in section 5, so the written procedure and the code still describe the same rule.
- If a point was **added**, write a new check_<id> function in checks.py, call it from run_all() in checklist order, name it in the point's implemented_by, and add tests for it to tests/test_checks.py.
- If a point was **removed**, delete its entry, its function and its tests.
- If a rule became **stricter or looser**, older runs must keep the rule they were made under. Do not simply change the function: give it a switch, pass the switch from run_all(), and declare it in the new YAML only, so the older files select the old rule by its absence. v3.2 did this for item 5: item5_on_nlp: true in v3.2.yaml, read by _item5_on_nlp in cli.py, selects the rule that the AUP and UAP must be linked from the NLP, and v3.0.yaml/v3.1.yaml, which lack the key, keep "on the NLP or in the Catalogue". Add tests for both rules, and rebuild the published run with the old file to prove it is unchanged.

Step 4: try the new revision offline, before switching. -c applies it to one run only. Re-scoring saved evidence contacts no one:

```
uv run basic-check points -c checklist/v3.3.yaml
mkdir -p /tmp/v33 && cp -r results/evidence /tmp/v33/
uv run basic-check assess -c checklist/v3.3.yaml --results /tmp/v33 --run trial-v3.3
```

Compare /tmp/v33/results.md with results/results.md. Any difference comes from the new rules alone, since the evidence is the same. If the published run skipped a node or used an older nodes.yaml, pass the same --skip and --nodes here.

Step 5: make it the default, and run the tests. In src/basic_check/cli.py:

```
DEFAULT_CHECKLIST = ROOT / "checklist" / "v3.3.yaml"
uv run pytest -q
uv run basic-check --help     # now says "against checklist v3.3"
```

The tests check the new file's hash, that its version matches its filename, and that every point maps to exactly one check_* function and every function to one point. They also check that v3.2.yaml and its document are still intact, so older runs can still be rebuilt with -c checklist/v3.2.yaml. What they cannot check is whether a rule is right: that is step 3.

Step 6: produce and publish the results. The default revision is now v3.3, so no -c is needed. Choose between the same two paths as in example 1:

```
# fresh evidence from every node:
uv run basic-check run --results /tmp/new-run --run live-2026-10-20-v3.3
# review, then:
rm -rf results/evidence && cp -r /tmp/new-run/evidence results/evidence
uv run basic-check assess --run live-2026-10-20-v3.3
```

Alternatively, re-score the published evidence against v3.3 without contacting anyone, as in step 4 but writing to results/. The report then says v3.3, while the capture date is still that of the evidence.

The reports now link to results/checklist-v3.3.html. The old results/checklist-v3.2.html stays behind; remove it, and update the places that name v3.2 in prose or links:

```
git rm results/checklist-v3.2.html
rg -n "v3\.2" README.md docs checklist/README.md .github
```

In README.md, the table of checklist points links each point to results/checklist-v3.2.html#p…. Those links break once the file is removed, so change them to v3.3.

Step 7: tests, review, commit. As in example 1, steps 5 and 6. If any check_* function changed in step 3, also update its decision procedure in section 5 of this document, which describes each point's rule branch by branch. Commit the new document, checklist/v3.3.yaml, cli.py, any changed checks and tests, results/ and the documents together, so the commit shows the whole change.

Source checklist: Node Landing Page Verification Checklist v3.2, 28 September 2026, transcribed to checklist/v3.2.yaml alongside the source document. Implementation: src/basic_check/{fetch,patterns,checks,names,privacy,report,cli}.py. Repository: https://github.com/marioreale/eosc-basic-compliance.